

Test Normal Cases

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can plan routine cases with expected results derived from the requirements.

I can compare a fixed prototype and manual baseline on the same requests.

I can report every result and explain what a small test set cannot establish.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Build a Paper Prototype. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Choose Inputs and Outputs. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Verify Important Outputs. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

Repeated success on ordinary cases is necessary but not sufficient.



LEARNING TARGET A sorter passes five routine cases and fails one. A team removes the failure as 'unusual' and reports 100%. Correct the report and propose a next test.

Learner name:

Readiness for the connected explanation

How does an expected result differ from an observed result, and why keep both when they disagree?

This week's end goal

By the end, I can test routine cases against expectations and count full passes honestly.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



MYSTERY The sorter is tested on five common classroom items with expected bins written before each run.

What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

GOOD THINKING A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

A closer explanation

This week you will turn separate paper traces into a test record. Choose several ordinary requests, write the required answers first, then run the same saved prototype on every request. Testing is useful when it can reveal a mistake, so keep failures as carefully as successes. A demonstration chosen because it works is not a complete evaluation.

Use catalogue B version 1 in order: B1 Bookmark drawing, 10 minutes, quiet Yes; B2 Story circle, 8 minutes, quiet No; B3 Pattern puzzle, 12 minutes, quiet Yes; B4 Tower challenge, 15 minutes, quiet No. These fictional values assume materials are available. Inputs are whole minutes from 0 to 30 and Quiet required Yes or No. Time must fit AND either quiet is not required or the activity is quiet. No allows either kind. Select the first fit with a correct reason; otherwise report no match. Missing or invalid input requires

clarification. No booking or publishing takes place.

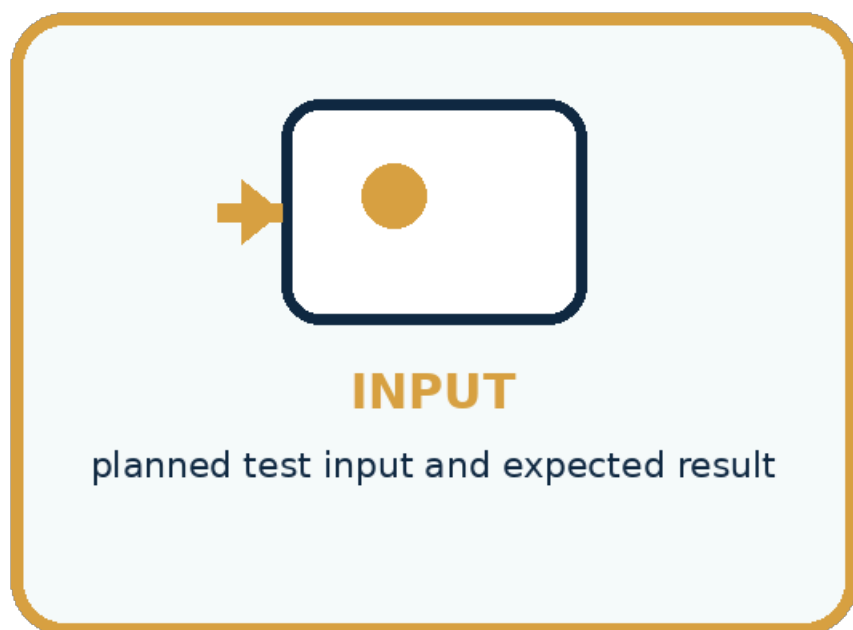
Keep the P1 version 1 instructions from Week 32: validate and stop with clarification if input is invalid; otherwise start at B1, check both conditions, suggest the first passing row and stop. After a failure advance one row; report no match only after all rows fail. Reset to validation and B1 for each new valid request. The manual baseline marks every row against both conditions and selects the first fit. Both methods must follow the same contract.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

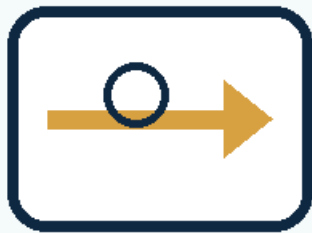
Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.





PROCESS

run unchanged prototype and observe



OUTPUT

actual result, pass/fail, and notes

INPUT planned test input and expected result

PROCESS run unchanged prototype and observe

OUTPUT actual result, pass/fail, and notes

CORE IDEA Repeated success on ordinary cases is necessary but not sufficient.

UNDER THE HOOD A test case includes input, setup, expected behavior, actual behavior, and result. Precommitting expectations reduces hindsight bias. Repeated normal tests establish basic reliability but say little about uncommon conditions.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

A closer explanation

From a planned case to evidence

Before the run · During the run · After the run

Before the run: Write input and expected result

During the run: Use the saved version

After the run: Compare with the requirement

Before the run: State why the case matters

During the run: Record output and reason

After the run: Mark pass or explain failure

Before the run: Label both comparison methods

During the run: Keep every trace

After the run: Report counts and limits

Keep the catalogue, requests and pass criteria the same for the prototype and baseline.

Give each case an ID. Record its exact input, purpose, expected output and expected explanation before running it. Then add observed output, observed explanation, pass or fail, and a trace reference. Put the prototype version, catalogue version and baseline method at the top of the sheet. A pass needs the correct result and a reason supported by the checked conditions; the right activity with a false reason is not a full pass.

Our routine set R contains four valid requests. R1 is 11 minutes Yes, checking an early quiet match. R2 is 9 minutes No, checking that the search reaches a later fitting row. R3 is 6 minutes No, checking that a valid request can exhaust the list. R4 is 9 minutes Yes, checking that a time fit alone is insufficient. These cases do not cover every accepted input or validation error.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

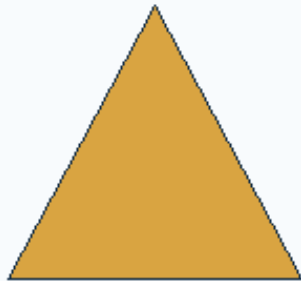
4. Compare the cases

Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



Pencil



Notebook



Expected written later



Same process each run

CASE 1 — Pencil Clue: common clear item. Meaning: normal case.

CASE 2 — Notebook Clue: common clear item. Meaning: normal case.

CASE 3 — Expected written later Clue: changed after result. Meaning: weak evidence.

CASE 4 — Same process each run Clue: controlled setup. Meaning: reproducible.

BOUNDARY Do not change the prototype halfway through a test set and combine results as if one version was tested.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Prototype reports none for request 6 instead of P1.

Prediction: That run still fails.

Reason: P2 can hold 6, so none is also wrong under the first-fit rule.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY

Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





expected result



actual result



Word · Meaning · My example

Word: test case

Meaning: planned input and expected behavior

My example: _____

Word: expected result

Meaning: prediction written before running

My example: _____

Word: actual result

Meaning: observed behavior

My example: _____

Word: reproducible

Meaning: another tester can repeat the setup

My example: _____

Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR Five passes prove the system is ready for every item.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Test set

Meaning: A collection of cases used together to check a version

Word: Pass criterion

Meaning: The requirement an observed result must meet to count as a pass

Word: Coverage

Meaning: Which conditions or behaviours the selected tests examine

Word: Baseline

Meaning: A simple comparison method tested under the same conditions

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EXAMPLE

Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



CASE The sorter is tested on five common classroom items with expected bins written before each run.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE planned test input and expected result

STEP 2 — TRACE run unchanged prototype and observe

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE actual result, pass/fail, and notes

MODEL REASONING Write the expected output first, keep the prototype version fixed, record every actual output, and count passes without deleting failures. Explain that five normal successes are necessary evidence, not full proof.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM Do not change the prototype halfway through a test set and combine results as if one version was tested.

What new evidence could change this answer?

A closer explanation

Case and request · Expected output and reason · Fictional observed Q version 0

Case and request: R1 11 minutes Yes

Expected output and reason: B1; 10 fits 11 and B1 is quiet

Fictional observed Q version 0: B1 with the same correct reason; pass

Case and request: R2 9 minutes No

Expected output and reason: B2; 8 fits 9, quiet unrestricted, B1 too long

Fictional observed Q version 0: B2 with the same correct reason; pass

Case and request: R3 6 minutes No

Expected output and reason: No match; all activities take longer

Fictional observed Q version 0: No match with the same correct reason; pass

Case and request: R4 9 minutes Yes

Expected output and reason: No match; B2 is not quiet and other rows take longer

Fictional observed Q version 0: B2 because 8 fits 9; fail

This is an invented record for a comparison prototype Q version 0, not a claim about your P1 runs. Q ignores the quiet condition when searching. Its trace explains the R4 failure. In the same fictional comparison, the manual baseline produced the expected result and correct explanation on all four cases: 4 of 4 full passes. Q achieved 3 of 4. The denominator includes the failed case.

On this set Q has fewer full passes than the baseline. This supports investigating its quiet check; it does not establish performance on all requests. Do not claim a speed advantage because we did not measure time. Correct implementations of P1 and the baseline can both pass all four, in which case these results show no correctness advantage for either method.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Test Normal Cases

A fictional pencil-pouch finder has been run on four ordinary requests.

The facts we will use

Catalogue: P1 capacity 3, P2 capacity 7; first fitting pouch. Valid whole counts 1–9.

Requests 2,4,6,8; recorded outputs P1,P2,P1,none. These are invented records, not class results.

Expected versus recorded routine outputs

	Request	Expected	Recorded	Result
Test 1	2	P1	P1	pass
Test 2	4	P2	P2	pass
Test 3	6	P2	P1	fail
Test 4	8	none	none	pass

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

Test Normal Cases

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Write expectations

For 2,4,6,8 expect P1,P2,P2,none.



2. Compare outputs

Runs at 2,4 and 8 agree; run at 6 disagrees.



3. Trace failure

P1 holds only 3, so it cannot satisfy request 6.



4. Report

Three of four routine cases pass; retain the failure.

CHANGE ONE THING

Prototype reports none for request 6 instead of P1.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Write expectations

What happens and why: For 2,4,6,8 expect P1,P2,P2,none.

Step: 2. Compare outputs

What happens and why: Runs at 2,4 and 8 agree; run at 6 disagrees.

Step: 3. Trace failure

What happens and why: P1 holds only 3, so it cannot satisfy request 6.

Step: 4. Report

What happens and why: Three of four routine cases pass; retain the failure.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

An ordinary case is not automatically correct. Define expected outputs from the contract before reading prototype outputs. Checking both selected ID and eligibility catches the wrong P1 suggestion. A no-match output can be a full pass when that is exactly what the valid request requires.

What this example does not establish

Four routine tests do not cover equality, invalid inputs or every relevant classroom condition.

7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

Case · Evidence · What it shows

Case: Pencil

Evidence: common clear item

What it shows: normal case

Case: Notebook

Evidence: common clear item

What it shows: normal case

Case: Expected written later

Evidence: changed after result

What it shows: weak evidence

Case: Same process each run

Evidence: controlled setup

What it shows: reproducible

Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A Five passes prove the system is ready for every item.

Repair:

CLAIM B A failed test should be removed because it lowers the score.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim _____ because the evidence shows _____. The process is _____. One limit is _____.

A closer explanation

A useful report names the version, catalogue, case set, full-pass count and total, then describes each failure and the requirement it breaks. Keep the trace so someone can reproduce the result. Say which conditions have not been tested. Four passing runs support a claim about those four runs; they do not prove that every possible request works.

For catalogue B, any request allowing B3 also allows the earlier quiet B1; any request allowing B4 also allows earlier B1 when quiet is not required. Therefore the first-match rule never selects B3 or B4 with this catalogue. Checking those rows in a no-match trace is different from testing a successful output from a later row. Next week we will deliberately examine boundaries and labelled catalogue variations while keeping the requirements explicit.

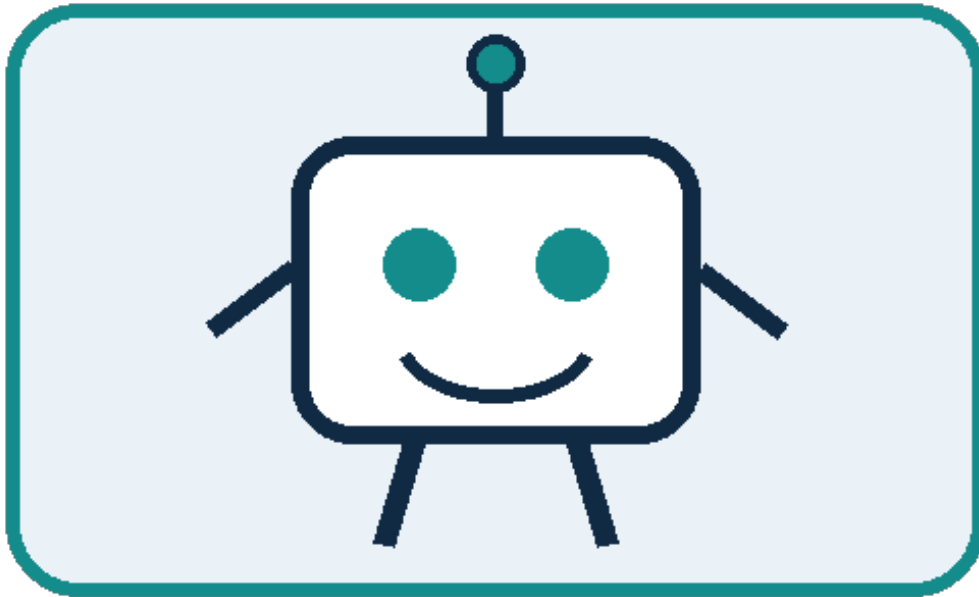
A team reports “Our prototype passed 4 of 4 routine cases, so it always works and is faster than the baseline.” Rewrite this as a claim supported by the evidence, and identify two further checks that would address different gaps.

8. Practise together

GUIDED PRACTICE

Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: Repeated success on ordinary cases is necessary but not sufficient.

Use a fresh example to explain test case.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: A failed test should be removed because it lowers the score.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

PARTNER CHECK Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

A closer explanation

Before testing your own cards, finish all four expected results and agree the pass criterion. Swap roles: one pupil operates and the other records. Keep the same version throughout the set and begin a fresh run for each request. Record what happened even if a card is ambiguous or the operator makes a mistake. A run that stops without a required answer is a failed run to investigate, not a row to delete.

Run the manual baseline on the same four requests and catalogue. Record its actual results too; a person

can make an error in either method. If you find a defect, preserve this set's results, save a new version and start a separately labelled set after the repair. Never combine the best result from each version into a score for one version.

In the fictional Q record, give the full-pass fraction for each method and explain the R4 failure. A teammate removes R4 and reports Q as 3 of 3. Explain how that changes the question being answered. Then state one condition that set R has not checked.

Practise with less help: Run a fair comparison

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Testing routine cases”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Testing routine cases. Proposed explanation: “A correct label is always a full pass”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Why is none correct for 8 but incorrect for 6? Use both capacity cards.

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

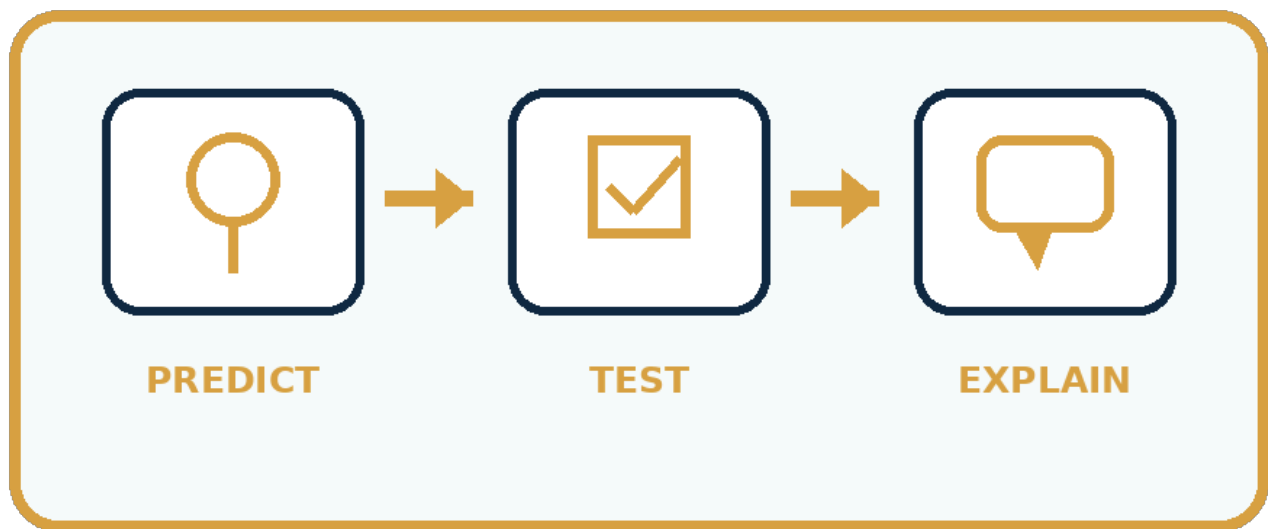
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

Five-Case Normal Test

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Run five planned tests and log expected versus actual.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

Case: Normal

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

Case: Edge

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Plan → try → check

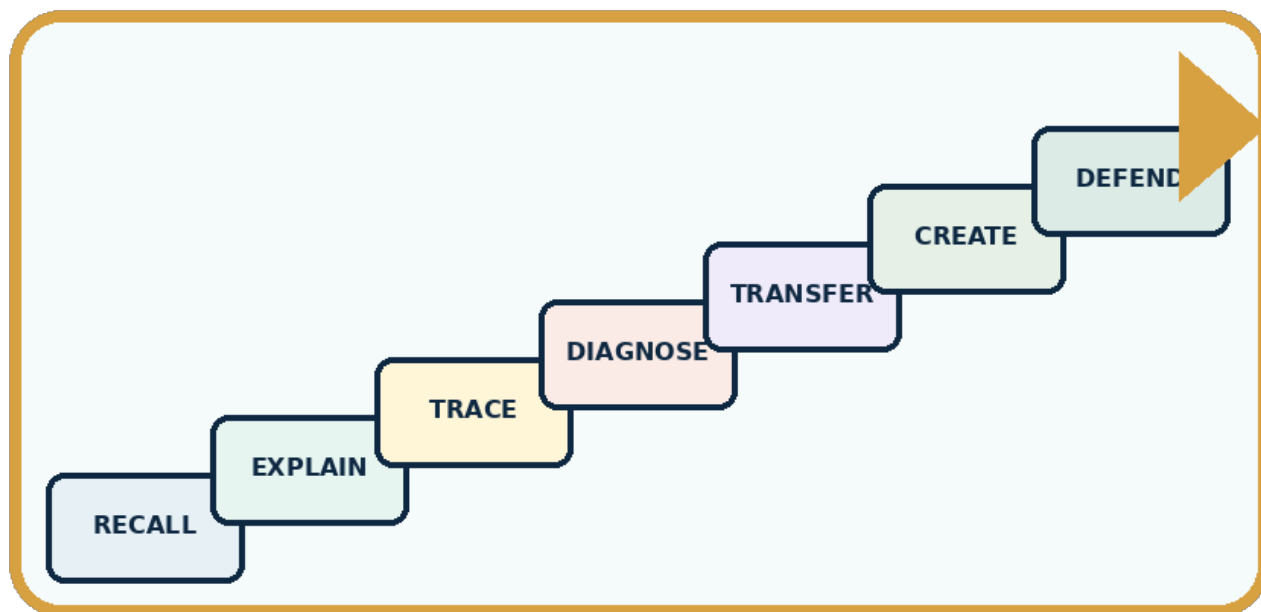
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define test case.

EXPLAIN Repeated success on ordinary cases is necessary but not sufficient.

TRACE Show the input, process, and output.

DIAGNOSE Repair: Five passes prove the system is ready for every item.

TRANSFER Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

CREATE Design one revealing test.

DEFEND Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

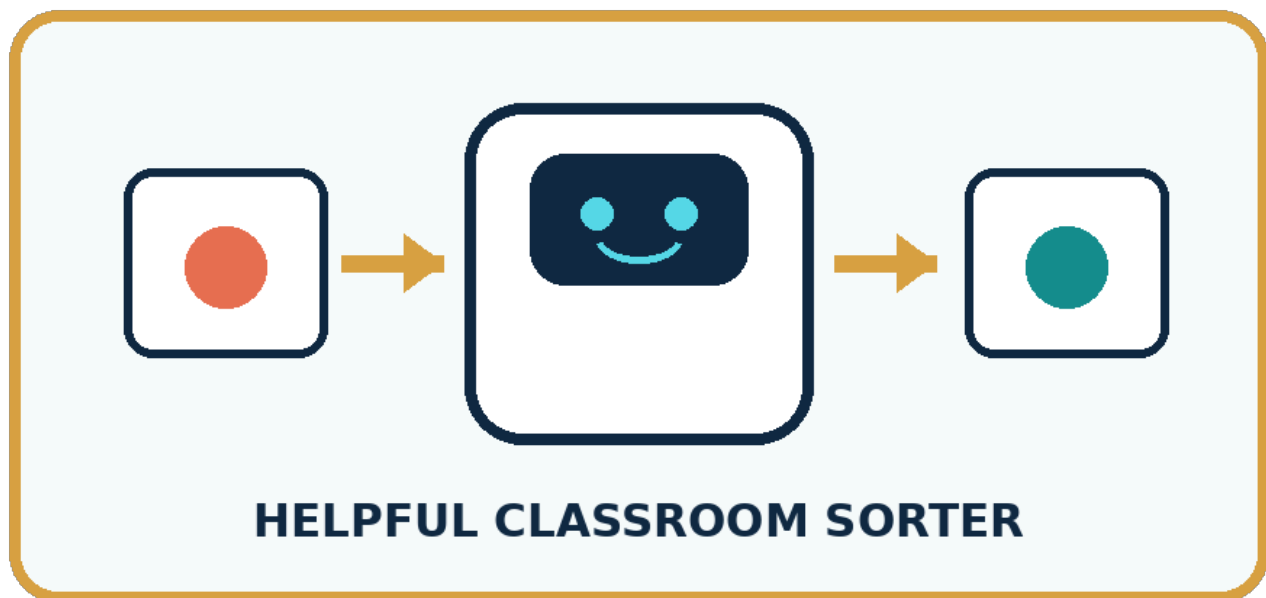
RETRY RULE A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

11. Connect your project

PROJECT

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Create and run the sorter's normal-case test plan with unique IDs and version label.

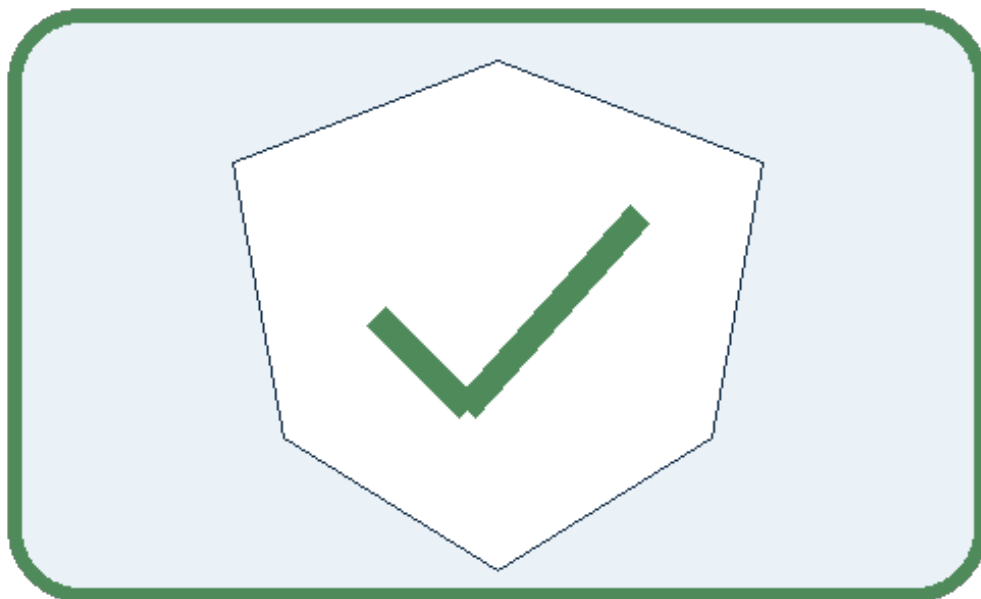
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Do not change the prototype halfway through a test set and combine results as if one version was tested.

My project decision:

Evidence for your project

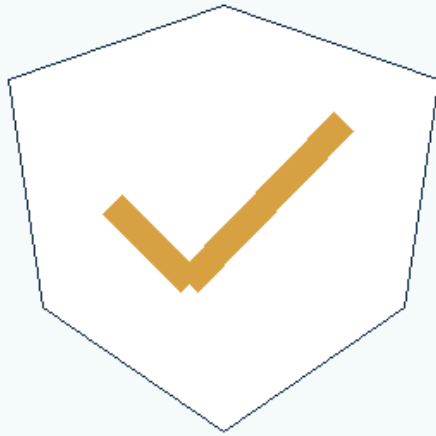
Maintain sorter tests with input, independently derived expectation, actual output, version and full-pass judgment.

12. Show what you know

MASTERY

Fresh-Case Independent Proof

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

REQUIRED PROOF Run five planned tests and log expected versus actual before calculating the pass count.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

SELF-CHECK Write the expected output first, keep the prototype version fixed, record every actual output, and count passes without deleting failures. Explain that five normal successes are necessary evidence, not full proof.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

NEXT BRIDGE Carry today's evidence habit into: Test Edge Cases and Fairness.

13. Study a complete case

Week 33 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

Four routine cases are chosen before testing. Three are correct.

The question

What can be reported?

Worked explanation

3/4 on those cases. Preserve the failure and trace its cause. This does not guarantee unfamiliar-case performance.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

Report the cases actually tested

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Routine cases

Value or result: 3/4

Four routine cases are chosen before testing. Three are correct.

What can be reported?

3/4 on those cases. Preserve the failure and trace its cause. This does not guarantee unfamiliar-case performance.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Audit a new test record

Independently audit this fictional equipment selector. Catalogue E has E1 first with capacity 4 and E2 second with capacity 8. Valid group sizes are whole numbers 1 to 10. Select the first item with capacity at least the group size, or no match; invalid input needs clarification. The saved prototype reports E1 for group 3 with reason “4 holds 3”; E1 for group 6 with reason “4 holds 6”; no match for group 9 with reason “both too small”. Write all expected results, mark full passes, calculate the fraction and explain the failure. Give one untested input category. No booking occurs.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 33 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

Test a sorter on two clear pencil cards and two clear book cards. It gets one book wrong. Report the result and keep the failed case.

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Create and run the sorter's normal-case test plan with unique IDs and version label.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

A sorter passes five routine cases and fails one. A team removes the failure as 'unusual' and reports 100%. Correct the report and propose a next test.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.